

Plan of the Day

- ◆ Budgeting Game Check In
- ◆ Portfolio Activity (Tuesday: Do, Thursday: Discuss)
- ◆ Investing Basics
- ◆ Investment growth is not linear...think probability!
- ◆ Mutual Fund Activity (time permitting)

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CWRU MGMT 205 Essentials of Personal Finance

Basics of Investing

Presented by

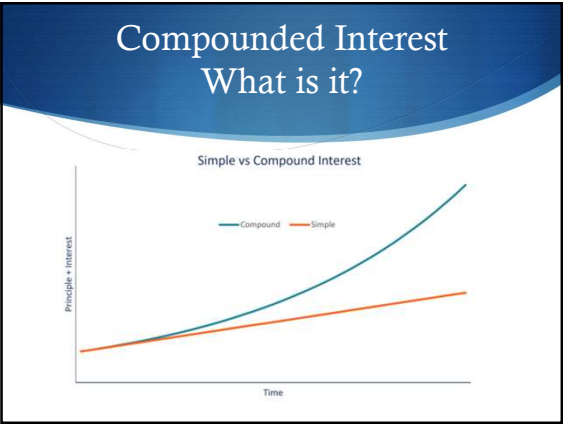
Mary Sasmaz, PhD, CPA, CFP
Department of Accountancy
Weatherhead School of Management
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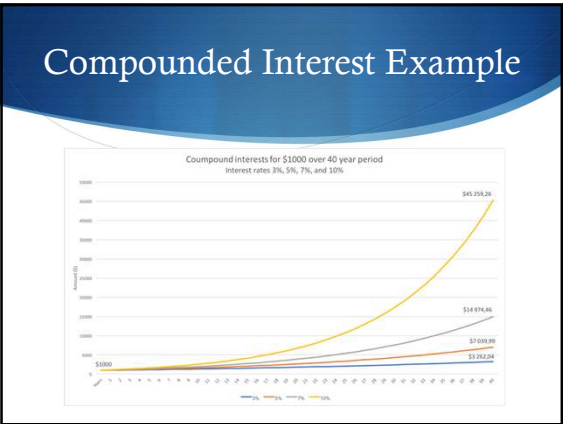
Agenda

- ◆ Quick Recap on Time Value of Money
- ◆ Investing for Retirement
 - ◆ Strategy
 - ◆ Investment Basics
 - ◆ Diversification

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Investments

- Investment strategy will differ from emergency fund or planned expense funds
 - Long-term
 - Regular Basis
 - Deal with Risk
- Risk vs Return - Note the retirement savings plan discussed previously assumes an average return/growth rate of 7.5% - requires taking on risk. (You need 4.5% after inflation).
- Many options – You need a mix
 - Stocks (i.e. equities)
 - Bonds
 - Funds
 - Mutual Funds / ETFs
 - Bond Funds
 - Index Funds



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Investments

Stocks (Equities)

- A share in the ownership of a company. If it's traded on the stock market, then the company is a “public” or “publicly owned”
- You own a little tiny piece of the company. You benefit from the performance of the company – stock value change and dividends, if any.

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Investments

Bonds

- A “fixed income” instrument that is basically a loan from the investor (lender) to the borrower (corporation / government).
- Ex. Company borrows money from you and promises to pay you interest while borrowing it and payback the principal amount at maturity.
- Bonds are priced based on current market rates, coupon (interest rate), credit rate of company, and borrowing period of time.

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Diversification

- Don't put all your eggs in one basket
 - Diversify your portfolio to reduce your investment risk
 - Age and Stage of Life will be factors in level of diversification
- Basic understanding
 - Equities – Risky
 - Bonds – Less risky than equities, (at least in short-term)
 - Cash – No risk
- Equities: Different industries, different size companies, different countries
- Bonds: Different industries, credit risks, maturities, countries
- The best plan is the one that lets you sleep at night. You must keep risk level within your own “comfort zone.”



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Diversification

- Advice will vary between advisors
- Advisor 1: Rule of Thumb – The Age Formula:
 - Age this year = 43
 - $110 - 43 = 67\%$ in Equities (33% in Bonds and Cash)
 - Age this year = 58
 - $110 - 58 = 52\%$ in Equities (48% in Bonds and Cash)
- Advisor 2: Rule of Thumb (Stock / Bond & Cash)
 - 50/50 until age 60, then switch to 40/60
- Some computerized systems build an asset allocation to you based on responses to a risk level questionnaire (ex. Betterment – Robo advisor) risk-level

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Investments

Mutual Funds / Bond Funds

- A “basket of investment securities” that is put together by an Investment Company
- Mutual/Bond Fund sells/buys shares to/from investors who want to invest in the fund (i.e. basket).
- Value changes based on the value of the securities in the fund/basket
- Can be widely diversified or concentrated in number of stocks/bonds and industry/ies.
- Minimum investment amount differs for each fund

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Short-term vs Long-term Results						
One (1) Year Annual Returns						
Portfolio	Best		Worst		1926 to 2013	
	Annual	Occurred In	Annual	Occurred In	Annual	Over 69 Yrs.
	Return	Year	Return	In Year	Average Return	Times Positive
Mix						
100 % S&P 500 Index	53.99%	1933	-43.34%	1931	12.05%	64
50% S&P 500 - 50% Govt. Bonds	34.71%	1995	-24.70%	1931	8.88%	69
100% Long-term Govt. Bonds	40.36%	1982	-14.90%	2009	5.91%	65

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Short-term vs Long-term Results						
Twenty (20) Year Rolling Period Returns						
Portfolio	Best		Worst		20 Year	Over 69 Periods
	20 Year	20 Year	20 Year	Occurred In	Annual	69 Periods
	Return	Period	Return	Year	Average Return	Positive
Mix						
100 % S&P 500 Index	17.88%	1980-99	3.11%	1929-1948	11.18%	69
50% S&P 500 - 50% Govt. Bonds	14.75%	1979-1998	4.60%	1929-1948	8.71%	69
100% Long-term Govt. Bonds	12.09%	1982-2001	0.01%	1950-1969	5.53%	69

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However, the probability of a positive return in the S&P 500 improves as holding period lengthens:	
HOLDING PERIOD	ODDS OF A POSITIVE RETURN IN S&P 500
1 month	59%
1 year	69%
5 years	79%
10 years	88%
20 years	100%

DATA SOURCE: BLOOMBERG, CRESTMONT RESEARCH, VANDERBILT RESEARCH. SHOWN IS THE ODDS OF A POSITIVE RETURN IN THE S&P 500 OVER DIFFERENT TIME PERIODS BASED ON DATA COLLECTED BETWEEN 1926 AND 2013.

The S&P 500 has been a profitable investment over every rolling 20-year period since 1928. That means owning an S&P 500 index fund for at least two decades has always been a profitable investment strategy.

Source: Motley Fool

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Things to Remember Long-term Perspective

- ◆ These funds are invested for retirement, not accessed before then.
- ◆ Don't look at your account balance every day – you'll go crazy!
 - ◆ **Trend in value** is more important in today's value. (10 to 30 years)
- ◆ Long-term growth – need equities/stocks
- ◆ Bonds and cash –lower the risk of over-all portfolio
- ◆ Don't freak when market drops, market lows are a good time to buy, but engaging in “market timing” is very difficult over the long period.
- ◆ Do your homework – don't invest in something just because someone else told you to – do your own research first.

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Yahoo Finance Mutual Fund Research Activity

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Next Time.....

- ◆ Active versus Passive Management
- ◆ Building a Portfolio
- ◆ Target Date Retirement Funds

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